ASHWINI CHAUDHARY

CTO | Product & Engineering Leadership | AI-Native Workflows | Hands-on

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PROFILE

CTO with 13+ years in software, leading product and engineering at Diversio. I took Optimo from internal launch to paying customers, set its AI direction, and still ship features in both products myself. I've also made AI part of how the whole company works, with an agent in Slack and GitHub used well beyond engineering and an automated PR reviewer, while completing SOC 2 Type 2 and cutting cloud costs by about 40%. I tend to pick up whatever is slowing a team down, whether or not it's my area, and fix it.

EXPERIENCE

Chief Technology Officer

Diversio Inc

Jul 2024 – Present Toronto

- Lead product and engineering for Diversio and Optimo. Took Optimo from internal launch (Nov 2025) to paying customers and pilots, own the roadmap with customer success and sales, and still ship features in both products myself.
- Set Optimo's AI direction with privacy built in from the start, and shipped Lumi, an AI assistant for managers. Also moved clients' sensitive HR files off email into a secure exchange inside the product.
- Built Courage, an AI teammate the whole company works with every day in Slack and GitHub. It helps sales, customer success, and marketing as much as engineering (41% of early requests came from outside engineering) and now runs most of our old manual processes. I rolled it out with people approving every change that matters, so the whole team could use it safely from day one.
- Built little-person, our automated PR reviewer, which reviews against our own standards and has reviewed 1,100+ PRs, taking human review out of the critical path while keeping AI costs low.
- Completed Diversio's SOC 2 Type 2 (Nov 2026), running it largely on my own with most checks and evidence automated, launched a public Trust Center, and closed every high and medium pentest finding. Moved every credential and API key off laptops into 1Password and managed secrets.
- Cut the AWS bill by about 40% year over year while staying in SOC 2 scope, brought CI costs down to almost zero since February by running it in-house, replaced a paid sandbox vendor with our own hardware, and cut deploys from 8–13 minutes to about 2.5.
- Built the developer tooling the team runs on: Dev Center (Rust), local-ci-runner (Go, open source), Pi extensions, and 23 Claude Code/Codex plugins in a public marketplace.
- Hire and mentor engineers and co-op students (University of Toronto, Queen's, Waterloo) through skill-based live interviews; led vendor rationalization and a successful SR&ED round.

LEADERSHIP FOCUS

- Product and engineering strategy
- AI in everyday work across the company
- Security, privacy, and SOC 2
- Platform, reliability, and cloud cost
- Hiring, mentoring, and team building

CORE STACK

TypeScript, Python, Go, Rust, Django, Postgres, AWS, Terraform, Docker, Redis, Pi, Claude Code, Codex, MCP, Linux, and Git.

RECENT BUILDS

Courage
AI teammate for the whole company on Pi Durable, in Slack, GitHub, and the CLI (Claude Code, Pi).

little-person
Automated PR reviewer on Temporal. 1,100+ PRs reviewed.

Lumi
Optimo's AI assistant for managers on web and Slack, with a performance review helper.

Dev Center & local-ci
Worktree dev environments (Rust) and local CI (Go).

Cineplex Seat Watcher
Alerts for specific seats and new showtimes. Live.

RECOGNITION

- Stack Overflow: 252K reputation, 3,700+ answers, ranked #287 overall.
- Unsplash: 218M+ views, 1.3M+ downloads, and top 1000 on the platform.
- Arctic Code Vault Contributor.
- Won Instamojo's hackathon for building a payments-powered vending machine.

WRITING

- Claude Code features you may not have tried yet
- All tools should now have two users
- How we use AI like engineers

Head of Engineering

Diversio Inc

Jul 2023 – Jun 2024 Toronto

- Led engineering execution through hiring, mentoring, delivery improvements, internal tooling, and engineering standards.
- Directed platform and stack consolidation after Diversio's acquisition of CCDI Consulting Inc.

Lead Engineer

Diversio Inc

Aug 2019 – Jun 2023 Toronto / Remote

- Early engineering hire who helped build core backend systems and infrastructure across multiple products.
- Owned infrastructure (Terraform, Terragrunt), deployments, and production operations.
- Led Diversio's first SOC 2 and multiple penetration testing rounds and their remediation.

Software Engineer

Unhaggle Inc

Nov 2017 – Feb 2021 Remote

- Owned infrastructure, site reliability, and deployments for the Dealer team.
- Built internal tools and delivered performance improvements in Python and PostgreSQL.

Senior Software Engineer

Instamojo

Mar 2015 – Oct 2017 Bengaluru

- Led backend work on card processing and storage projects.
- Built Instamojo's e-commerce plugins and SDKs across WordPress, Magento, Drupal, and others, plus Python, Ruby, and PHP wrappers.
- Delivered KYC onboarding, the Orders API, gateway integrations, and automated refunds, and helped port the main application from Python 2 to 3.

Python Developer

Simform Solutions

Sep 2013 – Feb 2015 Ahmedabad

- Built the real-time backend for SentMap using Node.js, Socket.IO, and Express to stream market and sentiment data over WebSockets.
- Built Django REST API backends and Twisted-based group chat for two mobile apps.
- No code by hand
- Protecting our own tenant in a multi-tenant SaaS

OPEN SOURCE

- Contributed to typeshed, mypy, django-debug-toolbar, pep8speaks, pgmpy, and others.
- Public tools: auto-uv-env, microverse, wt, ew, pi-cmux, clickup-mcp, local-ci-runner, and the Diversio agent skills marketplace.
- Spoke at MUPy and coached at Django Girls Bangalore.

EDUCATION

B.Tech. in IT

IMS Engineering College

2009 – 2013 Ghaziabad

LINKS

ashwch.com

github.com/ashwch

linkedin.com/in/ashwch

Stack Overflow

Unsplash